

Project Report Rubric

46-927, Spring 2021

Introduction & Conclusion

	Excellent	Needs revision
Motivates the problem	Introduction sets out questions to be answered (or methods to be described) and their importance	Unclear what the project intended to achieve or why it's interesting
Describes data source (if project uses financial data)	Introduction describes the source of the data and summarizes its relevance to the problem	Unclear where data is from
Conclusion presents results	Summarizes conclusions presented in report	Describes conclusions not justified or described in the body of the report

Scope of Project

	Excellent	Needs revision
Problem explored in appropriate depth	Project explores the problem in enough depth to demonstrate understanding of methods from the course	Project does not demonstrate understanding of methods in the course
Uses appropriate methods	Project uses methods relevant to the course	Project is unrelated to machine learning and finance
Follows up on interesting results	When there is an interesting result, follows up to try to figure out why it happened	Interesting results presented with no context (e.g. the model didn't work and you didn't try to figure out why not)

Results

	Excellent	Needs revision
Results clearly displayed	Text and figures explain what methods were tried and show the results	Unclear what methods were tried or what you learned from them
Results validated	Models or fits are appropriately validated using cross-validation or other error metrics	Validation is too optimistic, or no validation of results is presented

Problems noted	Caveats and problems are noted and their potential effect on results explained	There are obvious problems in the analysis that are not mentioned in the report
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Figures and Tables

	Excellent	Needs revision
Function and purpose	Connection between figures and narrative is clear from text and caption	Not clear what point the figures are making or how they support the argument
Legibility and design	Figures are clear, simple, legible, and attractive	Figures are hard to read; fonts are often too small; some graphics are blurry or squished
Labeling	All legends and axes are clearly labeled, including units	Labels missing or use raw variable names instead of descriptive text
Choice of figures	Types of figures are well-chosen, illustrating the intended points clearly	Figures do not make intended points and should be replaced

Writing and Graphics

	Excellent	Needs revision
Writing and style	Writing is understandable and style is appropriate	Style is informal or hard to read
Length	Report is ≤8 pages	Report is too long, or too short to cover the important points
Formatting	Formatting is clear and legible	Text is poorly typeset or in unusual sizes; figures are in inconvenient places
Sourcing (if applicable)	References are clearly given to information from outside sources; quotations clearly mark any verbatim text from sources	Some references not given; text or figures used without attribution. Warning: using text or figures from other sources without <i>clear</i> attribution is an academic integrity violation.
Citation style (if applicable)	Citations formatted in a common style used in statistics journals	Citations poorly formatted or incomplete